

# Zhiqun Li (Alice Lee)

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## Education

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| <b>Ohio State University</b> , Columbus, US                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2025-09-01 – 2031-04-30 |
| 2025 Fall Econ PhD Student                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | (expected)              |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Core Courses:</li><li>• Microeconomics:<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Semester 1: Econ 8711 (Individual Decision Theory) Econ 8712 (Equilibrium Uncertainty)</li><li>Semester 2: Econ 8713 (Game Theory) Econ 8714 (Mechanism Design)</li></ul></li><li>• Macroeconomics:<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Semester 1: Econ 8721 (Recursive Methods) Econ 8722 (Core Topics in Macroeconomics)</li><li>Semester 2: Econ 8723 (Core Policies in Macroeconomics) Econ 8724 (Asset Pricing Models)</li></ul></li><li>• Econometrics:<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Semester 1: Econ 8731 (Probability Theory and Statistical Inference)</li><li>Semester 2: Econ 8732 (Microeconometrics and Introductory Time Series Analysis)</li></ul></li></ul> |                         |
| <b>Southwestern University of Finance and Economics</b> , Chengdu, China                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2022-09-01 – 2025-06-30 |
| Master of Science (English-Medium Program)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                         |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Overall GPA: 86.5/100, Rank: 1<sup>st</sup>/8</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                         |
| <b>Harbin University of Commerce</b> , Harbin, China                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2018-09-01 – 2022-06-30 |
| Bachelor of Management                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                         |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Overall GPA: 93.43/100, Rank: 1<sup>st</sup>/74</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                         |

## Publications

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| <b>Household Energy Poverty and Personal Time Allocation: Empirical Evidence from China</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Published |
| Journal: <i>Utilities Policy</i> (Cite Score = 6.3) Role: First Author and Corresponding Author                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Coauthors: Prf. Shang Xie (Peking University), Prf. Dongming Wei (Peking University)</li><li>• Key Findings: This study reveals the significant impact of household energy poverty on personal time allocation. It shows that energy poverty increases housework time while decreasing work and leisure time through mechanisms related to health status, employment type, and single status.</li><li>• Responsibilities:<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– Research Idea Formulation: Developed the original research idea and framework, including identifying explanation variables, instrumental variables, and mechanism variables.</li><li>– Empirical Analysis: Conducted econometric analyses to validate hypotheses, including exclusivity analysis for IVs, two-way fixed effect analysis, robustness analysis, heterogeneity analysis, and mechanism analysis.</li><li>– Manuscript Development: Authored and revised key sections of the manuscript, including the introduction, literature review, empirical results, heterogeneity analysis, mechanism verification, conclusions, and appendix.</li><li>– Revision Work: Led discussions and analyses with coauthors during three rounds of revisions, taking primary responsibility for revision. Communicated with the editor and drafted the response letter.</li><li>– Publication Work: Proofread the manuscript upon acceptance. Effectively communicated with the production center to promptly resolve layout issues.</li></ul></li></ul> |           |
| <b>Poverty Alleviation Policy and Multidimensional Energy Poverty: Evidence from Explainable Machine Learning</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Published |
| Journal: <i>Sustainable Futures</i> (Cite Score = 4) Role: First Author                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Coauthor: Prf. Hanol Lee (Southwestern University of Finance and Economics)</li><li>• Key Findings: The article identifies the main factors contributing to household energy poverty through the XGBoost algorithm of machine learning and develops corresponding policy recommendations.</li><li>• Responsibilities:<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– Data Management: Pioneered data cleaning, including the China Family Panel Studies 2012- 2020.</li></ul></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |           |

- Machine Learning Analysis: Conducted XGBoost algorithm analysis and visualized the results.
- Conclusion Analysis: Discussed the practical and economic significance of results with coauthors and researched energy and poverty alleviation policies to explain the conclusions.
- Manuscript Development: Carefully reviewed the manuscript after the first draft was completed and provided my own suggestions for revisions.
- Revision Work: Collaborated with coauthors to discuss revision directions based on reviewer feedback, and conducted in-depth literature comparisons to enhance the manuscript.

### **Customer Acquisition, Competition, and Promotion of Weak Products—A Theoretical Analysis**

Published

Journal: *Economic Theory and Business Management* (Chinese Journal) Role: Third Author

- Coauthors: Prf. Xiaoyan Xu (Southwestern University of Finance and Economics), Prf. Jianyu Yu (Southwestern University of Finance and Economics)
- Key Findings: This study reveals the underlying economic rationale for E-commerce platforms offering free promotion of agricultural products.
- Responsibilities:
  - Manuscript Development: Collaborated in the theoretical exploration of E-commerce strategies for agricultural promotion.
  - Argument Development: Contributed to the development of the manuscript’s main arguments and conclusions.
  - Policy and Case Collection: Gathered relevant policy documents and commercial case studies, organizing and analyzing them to support the research.
  - Journal Submission: Assisted the first author in journal selection and submission processes, and monitored the progress of the peer review.

## **Manuscripts in Progress**

### **The Impact of Windfall on Marital Happiness: A Theoretical and Empirical Analysis**

Peer Review

Journal: *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics* Role: Sole Author

- Key Findings: This study theoretically analyzes how windfalls affect marital happiness based on reference-dependent framework and empirically validates the theoretical results. The main finding is that windfalls can significantly increase marital happiness for married individuals through consumption, leisure time, perception of current life, and prospects for future life. The increase in marital happiness exhibits a positive spillover effect on the mental health of family members.
- Responsibilities:
  - Theoretical Analysis: Proposed and developed a theoretical analysis framework and identified key results.
  - Empirical Analysis: Conducted data cleaning of two national survey databases and combined them to conduct regression discontinuity empirical analysis, including density check for assignment variable, smoothness test for control variables, polynomial fitness analysis, donut analysis, heterogeneity analysis, and mechanism analysis.
  - Manuscript Development: Drafted the initial manuscript, including the introduction, literature review, theoretical framework, empirical results, heterogeneity analysis, mechanism verification, further analysis, conclusions, and appendix.
  - Academic Communication: Communicated with Professor Andrew Clark and other scholars to seek professional suggestions after completing the manuscript. Incorporated his feedback to enhance the article’s quality.

### **Online and Offline Retailing: Mutual Benefit or Prisoner’s Dilemma?**

Under Review

Journal: *Electronic Commerce Research* Role: Sole Author

- Key Findings: This study investigates retailer’s channel decision under dual consumer heterogeneity. The first retailer to adopt an online channel gains a relative advantage in market share and pricing, but intensified competition reduces its absolute profit below the offline benchmark. This advantage encourages imitation, creating a prisoner’s dilemma in which dual-channel competition eliminates offline market power and drives both retailers’ profits to zero. Although this outcome harms retailers, it substantially increases consumer surplus and overall social welfare.
- Responsibilities:

- Idea Formation: Developed the core research idea based on my undergraduate thesis, generalizing its case-specific model into the broader theoretical framework used in my master’s thesis.
- Theoretical Analysis: Constructed the analytical model and solved for the equilibria under three market structures: a pure offline benchmark, an asymmetric structure in which one firm operates dual channels, and a symmetric dual-channel market.
- Manuscript Development: Drafted the initial manuscript, including the introduction, literature review, theoretical framework, figures, and appendices.
- Journal Submission: Adapted and substantially rewrote my Chinese-language master’s thesis into an English-language manuscript suitable for submission to an academic journal.

## Skills

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### • Software:

- Stata: Proficient in data processing and analysis, especially with Difference-in-Differences (DID), Regression Discontinuity (RD), and Propensity Score Matching (PSM) models.
- Python (Machine Learning): Skilled in implementing models such as Support Vector Machine (SVM), Ridge Regression, Decision Trees, Bagging, Random Forest, and XGBoost; algorithms such as Unsupervised Learning, K-means Clustering and Density-based Spatial Clustering of Application with Noise.
- MATLAB: Competent in handling symbolic analysis, optimization, statistical modeling, and graphical representations.
- Mathematica: Proficient in algebraic model analysis and mathematical modeling.
- MySQL: Experienced in database design and executing complex SQL queries.
- LaTeX: Proficiency in the use of LaTeX for paper layout, including formulas, graphs, and tables, and proficiency in collaboration using Overleaf.
- Visio: Proficient in utilizing Visio software to create flowcharts and framework diagrams.
- Microsoft Office: Proficient in Word, Excel, and PowerPoint.

### • Languages:

- English: Advanced proficiency
- Mandarin: Native speaker
- Japanese: Beginner and practice daily
- German: Basic reading and writing

## Research Experience

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### Research Assistant

April 2023 – September 2024

School of Economics, Peking University, Beijing

- Data Processing and Analysis: Responsible for the cleaning and organization of micro survey data.
- Theoretical Development: Proposed and advanced the theoretical framework for two projects.
- Econometric Analysis: Conducted comprehensive econometric regression analysis to validate and refine the proposed theoretical frameworks, driving insights from data.
- Manuscript Development: Explored and reviewed related academic papers to support research. Actively contributed to composing manuscripts.

## Conference Presentations

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### National Interdisciplinary PhD Forum on Digital Economy 2022

June 25, 2022

Wuhan University, China *Award: Second Prize*

- Presented paper: Customer Acquisition, Competition, and Promotion of Weak Products—A Theoretical Analysis
- Responsibilities: Prepared presentation materials, presented paper, answered audience questions, and incorporated feedback.

### China Agricultural and Forestry Economics and Management Annual Conference 2022

August 19, 2022

Renmin University of China, China

- Presented paper: Customer Acquisition, Competition, and Promotion of Weak Products—A Theoretical Analysis
- Responsibilities: Prepared presentation materials, presented paper, answered audience questions, and incorporated feedback.

#### **First Xiangzhang Energy Economics Forum**

December 9, 2023

China University of Geosciences, China

- Presented paper: Household Energy Poverty and Personal Time Allocation: Empirical Evidence from China
- Responsibilities: Prepared presentation materials, presented paper, answered audience questions, and incorporated feedback.

#### **Second China Economic Policy Evaluation Forum**

May 17, 2024

Nanjing Normal University, China

- Presented paper: Digital Government, Rural Family Entrepreneurship, and Urban-Rural Harmonious Development
- Responsibilities: Prepared presentation materials, presented paper, answered audience questions, and incorporated feedback.

#### **Young Scholars Symposium 2024**

June 29, 2024

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, China

- Presented paper: The Impact of Windfall on Marital Happiness: A Theoretical and Empirical Analysis
- Responsibilities: Prepared presentation materials, presented paper, answered audience questions, and incorporated feedback.

#### **The 27th Quarterly Meeting of the Labor Economists Forum**

November 3, 2024

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, China

- Presented paper: The Impact of Windfall on Marital Happiness: A Theoretical and Empirical Analysis
- Responsibilities: Prepared presentation materials, presented paper, answered audience questions, and incorporated feedback.

### **Academic Project Experiences**

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#### **Project Assistant**

September 2022

Research on Volume-based Procurement Indicator System (No: 030410005001010006)

- Compiled procurement rules and standards in the pharmaceutical industry.
- Revised the research report and formatted the document.
- Created and refined the presentation PowerPoint.

#### **Project Assistant**

October 2022

Economic Research on Monocyte Distribution Width (No: 030410005001010008)

- Researched and compiled existing reports on monocyte studies.
- Revised the research report and formatted the document.
- Created and refined the presentation PowerPoint.

### **Social Experiences**

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#### **Teaching Assistant**

February 2023 – June 2023

Operations Research and Information Management

- Addressed student inquiries and provided explanations on course material.
- Graded quizzes and homework assignments.
- Recorded assignment scores.
- Assisted the professor in final exams.

#### **Teaching Assistant**

September 2025 – January 2026

Econ&Soc Big Data

- Graded assignments.
- Recorded assignment scores.

#### **Teaching Assistant**

February 2026 – June 2026

Issues of Underground Economy

- Addressed student inquiries and provided explanations on course material.
- Graded quizzes, assignments, midterm, final exam.
- Recorded assignment scores.
- Assisted the professor in midterm and final exams.

### **Audit Intern**

January 2022 – March 2022

Grant Thornton International Ltd, Beijing, China

- Sent and received confirmation letters, verifying and reconciling information with clients.
- Conducted physical inventory counts to assess and settle client assets.
- Executed substantive audit procedures to verify accounting records.
- Assisted in the preparation of audit reports and reviewed report content for accuracy.

### **Marketing Intern**

July 2020 – September 2020

Pfizer China, Chengdu Branch, Chengdu, China

- Organized and verified information related to oncology drugs.
- Coordinated pre-meeting preparations, including meeting booking, setup, and material preparation.
- Assisted colleagues with compiling drug information for hospital clients, including creating and editing Power-Point presentations.

### **Volunteer Teaching**

January 2018 – February 2018

Tongqianguan Town Primary School, Xunyang County, Shaanxi Province

- Provided end-of-term tutoring for 6th-grade students.
- Conducted home visits for students in rural areas, offering support and care for their academic progress, living conditions, and family economic situations.

## **Awards & Honors**

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| National Scholarship (2020, 2021, 2024)                                             | Top 1%, National Level          |
| Outstanding Graduates (2022, 2024)                                                  | Top 1%, University Level        |
| Outstanding Student Scholarship (2019-2024)                                         | Top 1%, University Level        |
| Special Student Scholarship (2019-2022)                                             | Top 1%, University Level        |
| Meritorious Winner in Mathematical Modeling (MCM/ICM)                               | Top 7%, International Level     |
| Computer Software Copyright                                                         | 2nd Place, Team Project         |
| Utility Model Patent (Patent No: ZL 2020 2 1922825.6)                               | First Inventor                  |
| 1 <sup>st</sup> Prize in the Biology Olympiad                                       | Top 1% City Level               |
| 1 <sup>st</sup> Prize in Mathematical Modeling Contest (2021)                       | Top 1%, Province Level, Leader  |
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> Prize in Mathematical Modeling Contest (2022)                       | Top 5%, Province Level, Leader  |
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> Prize in National Management Decision Simulation Competition (2019) | Top 2%, National Level, Leader  |
| 3 <sup>rd</sup> Prize in National Management Decision Simulation Competition (2020) | Top 2%, National Level, Leader  |
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> Prize in National College Student Financial Elite Challenge (2019)  | Top 10%, National Level, Leader |
| 3 <sup>rd</sup> Prize in China Innovations Methods Competition (2020)               | Top 10%, National Level         |
| 3 <sup>rd</sup> Prize in “Challenge Cup” National Undergraduate Competition (2020)  | Top 3%, National Level          |

## **Personality**

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Friendly, outgoing, innovative, diligent, self-motivated, meticulous, collaborative. And I really love fashion.